exercise 4

On a separate paper, write a paragraph which begins with one of the sentences below. Make the first sentence your main idea. Use signal words for the listing pattern to complete the paragraph.

After you have written the paragraph, read it aloud to another student. Find out if your ideas are clear and interesting. Then rewrite the paragraph.

a. I would like to have a job as a _____ because...

b. Grandmothers are important for several reasons...

c. The most important invention was _____ because...

d. We need to protect the environment because...

e. The best features of my hometown are...

Sequence

This pattern is used for the organization of two kinds of material:

- events ordered by time
  Examples: history, biography
- steps in a process
  Examples: the steps in an experiment; directions for building something

The important idea is that things happen in a certain order. Some signal words for the sequence pattern:

first	next	last	after	at last
finally	later	before	while	at the same time

Other signal words for this pattern are dates, years, times of the day, seasons, and plain numbers.

Example a: Chronological Order (time)

Franklin D. Roosevelt, the thirty-second president of the United States, served his country for most of his life. He was the only president to be elected four times. He was born in Hyde Park, New York, on January 30, 1882, and he began his studies at Harvard in 1903. In 1905, he married Eleanor Roosevelt, a distant cousin, and they had six children. After serving in the New York State Senate, Roosevelt worked in Washington as Secretary of the Navy until 1921. At that time, he became very ill with polio and lost the use of his legs. In 1928, Roosevelt ran for governor of New York. After serving two terms as governor, he was elected to the presidency in 1933. Roosevelt died in office on April 12, 1945.

Main Idea:_____

_____



Note that each underlined word signals another period of time in President Roosevelt's life. Write the events that follow each signal word:

Signal Words	*Events*
January 30, 1882	_____
1903	_____
1905	_____
After	_____
1921	_____
At that time	_____
In 1928	_____
After	_____
in 1933	_____
April 12, 1945	_____

Example b: Steps in a Process

Making orange juice concentrate from fresh oranges is done entirely by machines. First, oranges are dumped onto a moving belt. They travel into a machine which washes them with detergent. Next they are rolled into juicing machines, where seven hundred oranges per minute are split and squeezed. Then the rinds (the skin of the oranges) are thrown out the end of a long tube. At the same time, the juice goes through small holes in the bottom of the tube. Next, the juice goes into another machine called the finisher. There, the seeds and other tiny objects are removed. Last, the juice goes into large tanks, where most of the water is removed.

Main Idea:_____

_____

Again, note the signal words. Each underlined signal word points to a step in the process of making orange juice concentrate. Write the steps in the process that follow each signal word.

Signal Words	*Steps*
First	_____
Next	_____
Then	_____
At the same time	_____
Next	_____
Last	_____

exercise 5

Read each paragraph. Look for the signal words and underline them. Then write the main idea, the signal words, and the examples on the lines below. Compare your work with another student.

Travel

1. A trip to another country requires a certain amount of planning. First, you must decide where you would like to go. Next, you need to look at maps and books about those places. When you have decided where to go, you should find out how to get there. An agent can tell you about ways to travel and the cost. Then, you should find out what kind of documents you will need to enter the country. In the meantime, you may want to find out the language spoken there. If you don't already know it, you might want to learn a few important words and phrases. Finally, you should make a packing list to make sure you bring everything necessary for a pleasant trip.

Main Idea: _____

_____

Signal Words	*Examples*
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

2. In the last seventy-five years, air travel has become the primary means of long-distance transportation around the world. The airplane was adopted for passenger service in Europe in 1919. Later, in 1927, people in the United States began to travel by air. In those days, people flew in small, two-engine propeller planes. Each plane carried 21 passengers and flew at about 305 km/hr. By 1950, planes could carry up to 100 passengers at about 480 km/hr. In 1989, the United States airlines alone carried about 452 million passengers, mostly on high-speed jet aircraft. The modern jetliner of the 1990s can carry more than 300 passengers at a speed of more than 885 km/hr.

Main Idea: _____

_____

Signal Words	*Examples*
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____